

Off-Page & Local SEO

Link building, digital PR and Google Business Profile

Why links matter

- Relevance beats raw quantity.
- Editorial links in body content carry the most weight.
- One link from a respected local news site can outweigh fifty spammy ones.

Link attributes and spam policies

- sponsored: paid placements.
- ugc: user-generated content.
- Never buy links that pass PageRank.

Reviews and local citations

- Ask for reviews routinely.
- Reply to every review.
- Fix inconsistent directory listings.

Ethical link-building tactics

- Build something worth linking to first.
- Personalised outreach, not mass email.
- Turn brand mentions into links.

Local SEO and Google Business Profile

- Accurate primary category.
- Complete profile with real photos.
- Consistent NAP across the web.

Good vs risky links

Link source	Verdict	Why
Feature in a national newspaper's tech section	Excellent	Editorial, relevant, trusted
Supplier lists you as an official partner	Good	Relevant business relationship
Paid guest post on a site selling links to anyone	Risky	Link scheme; may be ignored or penalised
500 directory submissions from a cheap package	Harmful	Low quality, manipulative pattern

Google Business Profile checklist

Field	Best practice
Business name	Real name only — no keywords added
Primary category	Most specific accurate category
Hours	Kept current, including holidays
Photos	Real exterior, interior, team and products
Reviews	Requested regularly and answered

Remember

- Earn links by creating things people genuinely want to cite.
- Label paid links and avoid link schemes entirely.
- For local businesses, the Google Business Profile is essential SEO.

Watch: Link Building Tactics for Beginners — Ahrefs (SEO Course, lesson 3.4) — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jTABfHvFpE>